

BRYANT CONG

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Analytics professional passionate about providing data-driven and actionable insights for the public and private sectors.

EDUCATION

University of Chicago, Chicago, IL

June 2023

Harris School of Public Policy

Master of Public Policy, Certificate in Research Methods

- PhD-level coursework in statistics, machine learning, and economics

University of Southern California, Los Angeles, CA

June 2021

B.S. Economics/Mathematics, B.A. International Relations

WORK EXPERIENCE

Charles River Associates

August 2025 – Present

Consulting Associate

Crime & Education Lab, University of Chicago

July 2023 – July 2025

Research Analyst

Chicago, IL

- **Contributed** to policy research and data-driven storytelling using rigorous statistical and data science methods.
 - **Deployed** causal inference models in **R** (differences-in-differences, regression) and built machine learning models in Python (LightGBM, lasso and random forest) to analyze data from Chicago Public Schools and the Chicago Police Department with 10+ millions of rows.
 - **Led** program evaluation of multi-million dollar funded policy initiatives ranging from [the largest individualized tutoring randomized control trial](#) (RCT) in the United States, policies to [reduce punitive discipline](#) in Chicago Public Schools, programs to [combat the opioid epidemic](#) in Chicago, and initiatives that provide [mental health programming](#) to youth at risk of gun violence.
- **Collaborated** with other analysts, data scientists, and managers to improve analytics infrastructure.
 - **Developed** internal **Gitlab** websites and automated report-generating pipelines in **Quarto** to present analytical findings to senior leadership.
 - **Spearheaded** quality assurance and reproducibility checks on RCT and other statistical findings generated from **power calculations**, **A/B tests**, and **cluster computing** on **SLURM**
 - **Led** data collection using methods such as web scraping using **Python** and **beautifulsoup**
- **Presented** quantitative findings to internal and external stakeholders.
 - **Co-authored** an op-ed published by the Brookings Institution on reforming school discipline in Chicago Public Schools.
 - **Edited** and provided writing support for the release of an [academic paper](#) published in the *American Economic Review* on punitive student discipline.
 - **Prepared** data visualizations using **ggplot** to summarize findings for Chicago Public Schools leadership and academic researchers.
- **Managed** direct reports and **organized** internal professional development opportunities in analytics and data science.
 - **Co-led** and **managed** event planning for a two-day internal data science conference, Datapalooza, attended by 60+ staff
 - **Supervised** an analytics intern in machine learning work (unsupervised clustering and causal forests) and provided career guidance.

PUBLICATIONS & WRITING

- **Cong, Bryant.** “[When Disaster Strikes: Assessing the Royal Australian Navy’s Preparedness for Humanitarian Assistance & Disaster Relief.](#)” *Soundings (Sea Power Centre - Australia)*, no. 17 (2020).
- **Cong, Bryant,** Jiayu Kang, Jiahe Fan, Benjamin Feigenberg, Anjali Adukia, and Fatemeh Momeni. “[A restorative approach to student discipline shows promise in reducing suspensions and arrests.](#)” Brookings Institution Brown Center Chalkboard.
- Various memos for the Federal Bureau of Intelligence and the National Security Council.
- Credited as the analyst on an academic [paper](#) in the *American Economic Review* and for a [white paper](#) on high-dosage tutoring.

SKILLS

- **Computing languages:** R (advanced), Python (advanced), SQL (intermediate), Stata (advanced), LaTeX (advanced)
- **Technical skills:** Causal inference/statistics/econometrics • machine learning • cloud computing • GIS • Policy writing • Microsoft Excel
- **Languages:** Mandarin Chinese (fluent); German (advanced); French (advanced); Spanish (intermediate)

LEADERSHIP & OTHER EXPERIENCE

Department of Political Science, University of Chicago

January 2022 – March 2022

Teaching Assistant

- **Led** teaching assistant sessions for the PhD-level course *Introduction to Linear Models*

University of Chicago Triathlon

2022 – 2023

Race Coordinator

University of Southern California Triathlon

2020 – 2021

Fundraising & Alumni Relations Chair

Recruitment Chair

2018 – 2020

AWARDS & HONORS

- **Interdisciplinary Contest in Modeling**, Finalist 2020
 - Top 3% of 2500+ teams as judged by a panel of academics